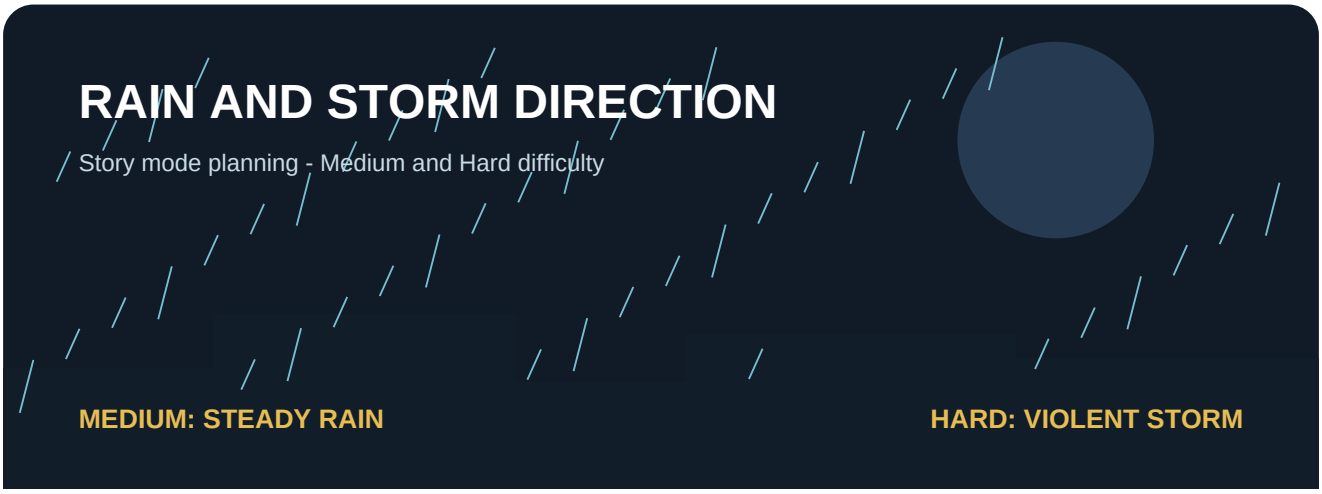
SILENT CITY

Story Mode Rain and Storm Design



Concept: Medium uses a steady, readable rain. Hard uses a darker and more violent storm. Weather strengthens atmosphere but never hides gameplay or changes physics without separate approval.

Planning only. No game files, scenes, scripts, effects, collisions, online mode, or multiplayer resources were modified.

Core weather direction

Medium adds tension through steady rain. Hard creates a full storm presentation. In both modes, approved encounter design - not visual obstruction - creates difficulty.

Element	Medium	Hard
Rain	Steady, 35-50%	Heavy, 70-85%
Wind	Light, visual	Strong gusts, visual
Lightning	Occasional	Dramatic, controlled
Gameplay physics	Unchanged	Unchanged
Readability	Always clear	Always clear

Visual layers

- Background: slow diagonal rain, clouds, distant lightning, and haze behind gameplay.
- Gameplay: restrained streaks and ground splashes that preserve silhouettes and attack telegraphs.
- Foreground: sparse larger droplets that fade during combat and precision jumps.
- Surface response: subtle wet tint and lantern reflections using approved project resources.
- Interiors: roof drips, leaks, window rain, and thunder instead of impossible indoor rainfall.

Fairness rules

- Rain must never create blind jumps, hide enemies, obscure hazards, cover UI, or cause unavoidable damage.
- Puddles, reflections, splashes, mist, and wet stone are visual only by default.
- Wind does not push the player and wet ground is not slippery unless separately designed and approved.

Weather by story level

Outer Graveyard

- Medium begins dry or with drizzle and becomes steady after the first story trigger or checkpoint.
- Hard begins with rain and grows heavier near the crypt and the Forgotten Path exit.
- Wet graves, fences, lantern reflections, and small splashes support the atmosphere without changing collision.

Forgotten Path

- Visible rain enters through outdoor ruins and broken ceilings; underground spaces use drips, runoff, mist, and distant thunder.
- Medium remains restrained. Hard uses stronger leaks, darker storm light, and gusts through exposed openings.
- Reduce rain sound before the Minotaur so footsteps, roars, and warnings remain clear.

Wizard's Sanctum

- Show the storm through broken roofs, windows, balconies, and courtyards instead of filling sealed rooms with rain.
- Lightning may support the Wizard's entrance, teleportation, barriers, and phase changes.
- Reduce foreground rain inside the boss arena so portals, projectiles, hazards, and the Wizard stay readable.
- After victory, weaken the storm, lighten the rain, open the clouds, and support the return of light.

Transitions and story timing

- Fade visual density over roughly 1.5-3 seconds and ambience over roughly 2-4 seconds.
- Reduce weather during dialogue, checkpoint activation, important reveals, and visually complex attacks when needed.
- Restore the correct weather after death, checkpoint reload, pause, scene transition, and return to menu.

Available Rain shader analysis

Supplied shader: `../Rain/rain_and_snow_shader.gdshader`
License: `../Rain/Rain and Snow Shader MIT Licence.rtf`
Author: Brian Smith (steampunkdemon.itch.io), copyright 2023, MIT license.

The asset is a procedural Godot **canvas_item** shader. It creates near and far falling streaks from UV coordinates and exposes density, length, width, transparency, color, speed, and slant. It does not provide splashes, puddles, wet reflections, mist, thunder, lightning, physics, collision, or gameplay effects.

Important current state

The smooth **blurred-trail rain expression is commented out**, while the sharp **no-trail snow expression is active**. Used unchanged, it will look more like sharp snow or short falling marks than soft rain trails. A later approved implementation should switch those expressions for rain; this planning update does not edit the shader.

Starting values for testing

Uniform	Medium start	Hard start
rain_amount	140-180	220-300
near length	0.18-0.24	0.24-0.34
far length	0.08-0.12	0.12-0.18
near width	0.45-0.70	0.65-0.90
far width	0.20-0.40	0.35-0.55
near transparency	0.55-0.75	0.70-0.90
far transparency	0.25-0.45	0.40-0.60
base speed	0.45-0.60	0.65-0.85
additional speed	0.25-0.45	0.35-0.55
slant	0.10-0.25	0.25-0.45

Never set `rain_amount` to zero because the shader divides by it. Fade the owning CanvasItem or its visibility when rain must disappear, or add a separately approved intensity control.

Recommended use

- Place it on a story-mode-only screen-sized CanvasItem behind UI and ahead of the distant background.
- Use independent material instances so Medium and Hard settings do not alter shared resources.
- Retain the MIT copyright and permission notice with the shader.
- Treat this as the main streak layer; approved assets are still needed for splashes, sound, lightning, mist, leaks, and wet surfaces.

Available rain and thunder sound

Audio: `../Rain/Rain_And_Thunder_5min.flac`

Property	Detected value
Format	FLAC, stereo
Sample format	44.1 kHz, 24-bit
Exact duration	319.929 seconds (5:19.929)
File size	60,332,138 bytes (57.5 MiB)
Average bitrate	Approximately 1,509 kbps
Embedded ownership/license tags	None found
Seamless loop	Not verified

License boundary

The shader's MIT license applies only to the shader. It does **not** establish redistribution permission for this FLAC. Record the audio source and license or obtain permission before shipping the game.

Loop and import guidance

- Treat it as a long ambient bed, but test the first and last seconds and use a short crossfade if the seam is audible.
- Prefer a streaming/import mode suitable for a five-minute ambience file and test memory in the target build.
- Put it on a story-mode weather bus separate from dialogue, combat, UI, and warning sounds.
- Medium uses a restrained baseline. Hard may raise it modestly, but critical cues must stay clearer and louder.
- Duck weather during dialogue, memories, Minotaur warnings, Wizard attacks, checkpoints, and important story events.
- Do not alter pitch or playback speed for Hard mode; adjust level, layers, and timing instead.
- If thunder conflicts with gameplay timing, later use a rain-only bed plus separately controlled thunder assets.

Readability, accessibility, and performance

- Keep player, enemy, hazard, checkpoint, exit, and platform-edge silhouettes stronger than the rain.
- Never draw dense foreground rain over UI, subtitles, dialogue, boss health, or interaction prompts.
- Offer weather quality settings: Low reduces particles and splashes; Medium preserves the intended look; High adds secondary effects.
- Provide reduced-lightning support, avoid rapid repeated flashes, and keep critical audio above rain, thunder, and wind.
- Test at the lowest supported resolution and performance target.
- If weather resources are shared with online mode, duplicate or isolate story-mode copies before implementation.

Asset and portable-path boundaries

Use only weather visuals, sounds, particles, shaders, and scene resources already present in the Silent City project unless the user later supplies or approves additional assets. Inventory first; if something is missing, report it instead of downloading or generating replacements. Confirm the source and redistribution license for the supplied FLAC before shipping.

Reference every related PDF, image, scene, asset folder, or supporting file with a **relative path from this document or the agreed project root**. Never use a fixed drive letter, Windows username, home folder, or computer-specific absolute path.

Approval decisions for later

1. Confirm whether Easy is fully dry or may use decorative drizzle.
2. Confirm whether rain remains visual only or gains an approved wet-ground mechanic.
3. Inventory the real rain, thunder, wind, splash, mist, and wet-surface assets.
4. Tune exact Medium and Hard intensity using the real characters and levels.

Copy-paste implementation prompt

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Design and later implement a story-mode-only rain and storm system for Silent City after receiving explicit approval. Do not modify online mode, multiplayer systems, online maps, networking, or shared resources. If a needed effect is shared, duplicate or isolate a story-mode copy first.

Medium difficulty uses steady, readable rain with light wind, subtle wet surfaces, restrained splashes, soft thunder, and occasional accessibility-safe lightning. Hard difficulty uses a denser and darker storm, stronger visual gusts, more dramatic thunder and lightning, and stronger scene reactions. Rain and wind do not change character physics, traction, jumping, attacks, damage, or enemy behavior unless separately approved.

Keep the player, enemies, hazards, platform edges, checkpoints, exits, projectiles, attack telegraphs, UI, subtitles, and story events clearly visible. Never create blind jumps or hide danger with rain. Reduce foreground rain during precision platforming, dialogue, and complex boss attacks.

For Outer Graveyard, build from drizzle to steady rain on Medium and from steady rain to a heavier storm on Hard. For Forgotten Path, use rain through ruined openings and use leaks, drips, runoff, and mist underground. For Wizard's Sanctum, keep the storm visible outside and use rain only through exposed architecture; let lightning support the Wizard's arrival and boss phases without obscuring combat. After the Wizard is defeated, weaken the storm and allow light to return.

Use the supplied shader at `../Rain/rain_and_snow_shader.gdshader` as the candidate main rain-streak layer, and keep its MIT notice from `../Rain/Rain and Snow Shader MIT Licence.rtf`. The shader's blurred rain-trail line is currently commented out and its sharp no-trail snow line is active; propose the exact story-mode-only change before editing it. First inventory any additional rain, splash, sound, lighting, mist, and wet-surface resources. If required assets do not exist, stop and report what is missing instead of downloading or generating replacements.

Use `../Rain/Rain_And_Thunder_5min.flac` as the candidate long ambience track. It is a 5:19.929 stereo, 44.1 kHz, 24-bit FLAC and is not yet confirmed as a seamless loop. Test its beginning/end transition, import memory, thunder timing, dialogue ducking, and weather-bus mixing before implementation. The file contains no embedded ownership or license tags, and the shader MIT license does not cover it; confirm the audio source and redistribution permission before shipping.

Use relative paths for every referenced PDF, image, scene, asset folder, or supporting file. Never use a drive letter, Windows username, home folder, or machine-specific absolute path.

Before changing the game, return: an asset inventory, proposed story-only scene structure, Medium and Hard weather settings, per-level weather zones, transitions, readability safeguards, accessibility settings, performance budget, test plan, and exact files that would change. Wait for approval before implementation.
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